



into kilo-ohms. Such content is one of the most visited pages from India. It is number one in India. So that tells me that the engineering population we have in India is very education and learning oriented. They come and access the free content available almost like no other country.

How has the trend for sales been for the past two years from India?

Through the years it was explosive. I think we recorded double-digit growth in India almost every year. Obviously, the pandemic drove some of that. I don't know whether that will continue next year. Everybody is talking about a slowdown. We are seeing some slowdown but my personal take based on some of the early data is that growth in India may not go down; it may stay stable.

As I mentioned earlier, some of the manufacturing is shifting to India and that is just starting to create an ecosystem of demand for us. So, I'm hopeful it will stay, but we've witnessed huge growth in the last two years.

Since we are talking about sales, do you plan to enrol any channel partners to expand sales in India to serve many of the un-penetrated regions in India?

Honestly, the answer is no, not right now. We are channel partners for our suppliers. We have to figure out a way to penetrate every place as opposed to somebody reaching out to us. We find that engineers complain about having multiple layers of partners before they get their product. The price increases and it takes time. We have proven that we are good in both of those areas. So, our plan is to reach every nook and corner on our own. We have plans for that, and we are not planning to have another layer between us and the customer.

When will the India office be ready and functional?

Oh look! I'm sitting in the office that is already up and running. We have about 50 people in this office today. Our offices in Gurgaon and Delhi have also been up and running. It's just the paperwork, I don't know when that will complete; I can't even give you a date. I wish the government moves faster on us, but our office is ready to go.



Have you finalised any leaders to help these local operations?

Yes, we have Arun Arasu, who is our Managing Director for India. He's been in the role for about five months now. He's still learning, but he's operational.

How do you see the overall trend for e-commerce for electronics components and equipment across the globe? And then specifically with respect to India?

Almost everyone in the name of digital transformation is investing in electronics—whether it is IoT or creating digital twins in an automated warehouse, to digitise what is physically present. This is a tiny example of what we have done. We see the trend of electronification. Even during the recession, people wanted to go digital to cut costs so that they could manage the recession. We are in a good industry, where we see growth—no matter what—because of electronics.

Coming to the e-commerce question, a lot of people in the electronics industry are still very traditional. We have the manufacturers of electronic products, then people like us who are in the middle and are e-commerce distributors, and then we have the customer. Everybody wants to cut the middleman, but the unique thing about electronics is that you can go to Amazon to buy a finished product. That is why we are in the maker industry.

So, the electronics e-commerce distributors and e-commerce websites are here to stay because we give the whole bill of material to the engineers to build. We provide them with small quantities that big manufacturers cannot afford as they have a minimum order quantity, which is in millions sometimes. We sell even one part that is worth only 40 cents. We spend \$20 to ship it to you, but you can still buy 40 cents worth of parts from us without any hassle. So, I think e-commerce for electronics is here to stay and we do add value for the customers, be it by giving small quantities of materials or by taking care of different countries' logistics, or providing reference design libraries.

Coming to the last part of the question, India is a broad market for us. In the UK people are curious because we always say our customers are makers, our customers are innovators, and we find a lot of them. I think our educational system is allowing engineers to be produced in mass and that is leading to be a very innovative thing as I can now see people are making products in India.

So, all these factors are helping a company such as Digi-Key to be here. It is the perfect timing for growth and innovation. I am so thrilled to see that. I feel proud to be from this country where I am literally seeing transformation in everything, not just in electronics, and that is something to be proud of. **EFY**